PIANO BUTLER



The Butler's

Keys

A companion to every room of music

Pitch, time, harmony, expression, form and history, from the whole picture to the smallest detail. For any piece, any method, from the first lesson to Level 8.

PREPARED BY THE PIANO BUTLER · THEPIANOBUTLER.COM

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A map of music

Six parts, from the largest idea to the smallest detail. Read a part from the start for the whole picture, or go straight to the table you need.

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PART II

Time

Music moves through time. Underneath it runs a steady **pulse**; the pulse is grouped into **bars**; and every note and rest takes up a measured share of it. This part goes from that big picture down to the length of a single note.

1 **Pulse** — the steady beat underneath

›

2 **Bar** — beats grouped: 2, 3 or 4

›

3 **Time signature** — how many beats, and which note is one beat

›

4 **Note values** — how long each note lasts

›

5 **Rhythm** — the pattern of long and short

IN THIS PART

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PART II · TIME

Notes and rests

A note's shape shows how long it lasts. Each plain note lasts **half as long** as the one above it; a **dot** adds half the note's value again. Every note has a rest of the same length: a silence, counted just as carefully.

NOTE	REST	NAME	BEATS*	FIRST MET
		**breve**	**8**	Level 4
		**dotted semibreve**	**6**	*beyond Level 8*
		semibreve	**4**	Level 0
		**dotted minim**	**3**	Level 0
		**minim**	**2**	Level 0
		**dotted crotchet**	**1½**	Level ½
		**crotchet**	**1**	Level 0
		**dotted quaver**	**¾**	Level 3
		**quaver**	**½**	Level 0
		**semiquaver**	**¼**	Level 2
		**demisemiquaver**	**⅛**	*beyond Level 8*
		**hemidemisemiquaver**	**1/16**	*beyond Level 8*

* With the crotchet as one beat, as in 2/4, 3/4 and 4/4.

Groups of other sizes



Triplet: three notes in the time of two.
Level 2



Duplet: two notes in the time of three.
Level 3

See also

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Rhythm 44

Practise it

Workbook Level 0 · Note values
Online · Library › Notes and rests